

00 COMPANYGRAPH, DESCRIBED IN COMPANYGRAPH —

CompanyGraph explains its own Obsidian plugin

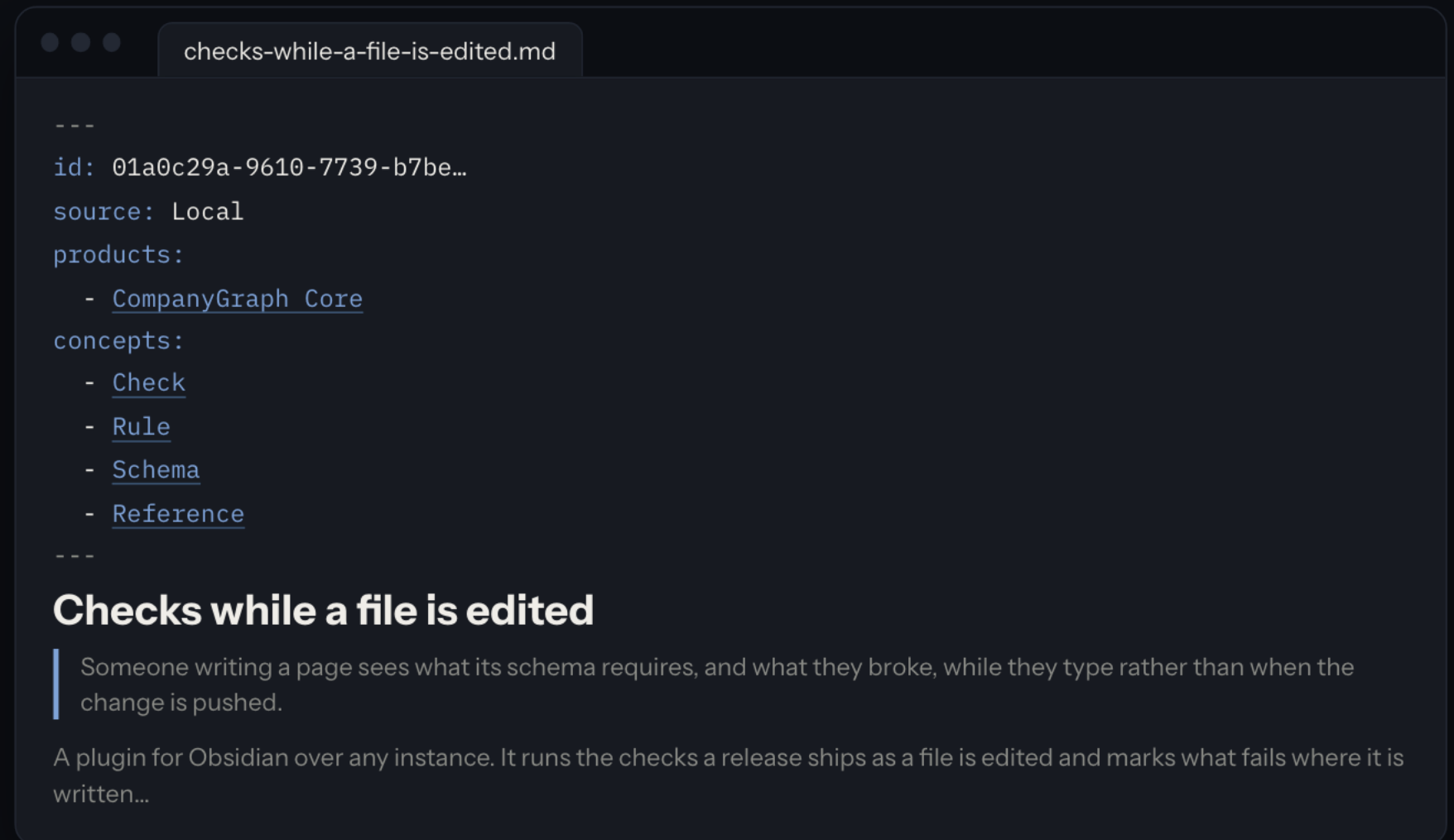
Every pane and every feature, read from the model it edits.

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The plugin has a page in the model it edits

CompanyGraph describes itself in CompanyGraph. The plugin is one feature of the product CompanyGraph Core, and this is its page as the repository holds it.

Its concepts are this talk's vocabulary.



An instance is a folder of Markdown files. So is a vault.

What a vault lacks is what an instance's CI supplies after the edit: a reference that resolves, and no field its schema does not declare. The plugin says so while the edit is made, and implements no rule of its own.

RESTS ON `concept Instance` `concept Core` `concept Check` `decision Core is vendored into an instance at a release its manifest names`

Where each part sits in Obsidian

The editor

Failures marked on their line, completion from the schema, names that open what they name, held headings, a picture at the H1.

Meta-model compliance

Every failure in the instance, by file.

References

What names this entity, and what it names.

The status bar

The failure count, and the pin when it differs.

Writing brief

What the schema says of the place the cursor is in.

A failure is marked where it is written

Every change checks the whole model, because a reference crosses files. A failure gets a mark on its line, a row in the pane and a count in the status bar.

Copy report puts the pane on the clipboard, for an agent or an issue.

RESTS ON

concept Check

concept Rule

concept Reference

2026-vendored-core.md

```
---
id: 01a0dd52-bc30-73db-a8ef...
source: Local
decided: 2026-08-25
kind: Architecture
status: Standing
by: Architect
---
```

Core is vendored into an instance...

> An instance carries a copy of core at
> the release its manifest names...

META-MODEL COMPLIANCE

decisions/
2026-vendored-core.md
line 7
by names "Architect", and no role has that name

Copy report

● CompanyGraph: 1 failure

What names an entity, and what it names

The pane follows the note in front. Each entry says where the name stands, a field or a section and its column, and opens that line.

While a vault is an instance, Obsidian's backlinks, outgoing links, properties and tags panes are off: none of them knows a name a schema declares.

RESTS ON concept Reference concept Canonical name

● ● ●

implementer.md

Implementer

|

The seat that turns one task brief into a tested commit and a report, and nothing beyond the brief.

What it takes

A task brief that is the whole of its requirements, the interfaces earlier tasks produced, the repository's own agent file and a path for the report.

REFERENCES

Named by

Implement executed-by

AI Agent roles

An agent's commit is authored... Bears on

· Entity

Names

Nothing

● CompanyGraph: complies

The schema's rules, where the writing happens

The brief follows the cursor. It names the place, says whether the schema requires it, and shows the rules that name it.

A section or field in a rule is a chip that moves the cursor there. The type's other rules fold under the place each one names first.

RESTS ON concept Schema concept Rule

2026-vendored-core.md

Core is vendored into an...

> An instance carries a copy...

The question

How the vocabulary reaches a company's model, and who decides...

Alternatives

| Option | Why not |

Why

The version number below 1.0 is doing work: the vocabulary is free...

DECISION ● required

SECTION **Why**

What turned it: the reason the chosen option won

THE RULES FOR THIS

\$ The question ... the reasons are

\$ Why .

\$ Why gives the reason the chosen option won, concretely enough to tell whether it would still win today.

OTHER RULES

› TITLE	Decision	1
› SECTION	Consequences	1
\$ Consequences names what the company is now committed to and what it gave up...		
› FIELDS	Frontmatter	5

● CompanyGraph: complies

It offers what the schema declares, and only that

A reference field offers the canonical names of its type, an enum its permitted values, a table cell what its column declares.

A name resolves by the type its schema declares; a name that exists only under another type is not offered.

RESTS ON concept Schema concept Canonical name

decision A reference resolves by its declared type, never by name alone

2026-a-new-call.md

id: 01a0dd52-bc30-73db-a8ef...

source: Local

decided: 2026-09-30

kind: Architecture

status: Standing

serves:

-

A company we have never met keeps its own model

A company keeps its model with whichever agent it chooses

Every gate an agent's work passes is held by a person

Core holds a company without running out of vocabulary

CompanyGraph: complies

Add property knows the schema

In Live Preview, Add property lists exactly the fields this file's schema declares and the file lacks, the required ones first.

Its last entry hands over to Obsidian's own list, for a field the checks will then report.

RESTS ON concept Schema

decision A section is open and a field is closed

2026-a-new-call.md

PROPERTIES

id	01a0dd52-bc30-73db...
source	Local
decided	2026-09-30
kind	Architecture
status	Proposed

+ Add property

by · required

serves

upholds

supersedes

Another property...

CompanyGraph: 1 failure

A declared name reads as a link

A name a schema declares is drawn as a link, and one that names nothing as an unresolved link. Cmd-click opens the entity it names.

The model's edges reach Obsidian's graph view, so an entity's neighbors there are the ones the model names.

RESTS ON `concept Reference`

```
decision A reference resolves by its declared type, never by name alone
```

2026-vendored-core.md

```
---
decided: 2026-08-25
kind: Architecture
status: Standing
by: Owner
upholds:
  - Run on what we publish
supersedes:
  - Core is copied by hand
---
```

No decision has this name.

CompanyGraph: 1 failure

Declared headings are held, a missing one is drawn

A required section the page lacks is drawn where the schema puts it, and one click writes it. Add a section and Remove section do the rest.

A heading the schema declares is held against a stray edit. A section of the page's own is allowed.

RESTS ON concept Schema

decision A section is open and a field is closed

2026-vendored-core.md

Core is vendored into an instance

The question

How the vocabulary reaches a company's model...

Alternatives

Resolve core at read time · A git submodule

Why

The version number below 1.0 is doing work...

+ Consequences · required, missing

Bears on

| concept | Core | | changed it |

● CompanyGraph: 1 failure

New, Rename and Delete keep every reference

New entity writes a page with its required fields and sections.
Rename entity rewrites the name in every file that uses it.

Delete entity lists the references it would leave naming
nothing, before anything is deleted.

RESTS ON

concept Entity

concept Canonical name

concept Reference

Rename entity

roles/implementer.md

Implementer

processes/delivery/phases/implement.md

executed-by

New name for Implementer

Builder

profiles/...

roles: - Implementer

decisions/2026-commits-by-seat.md

| role | Implementer | | changed it |

A demonstration: nothing here was renamed

An id is set once and locked

Every page carries an id that outlives its name. The plugin writes one on every new page and refuses an edit that changes or removes it.

Copy entity id copies it. Give this page a fresh id replaces it, once you confirm.

RESTS ON

- decision Every entity carries an id that outlives its name
- concept Entity

2026-vendored-core.md

PROPERTIES

id	01a0dd52-bc30-73db-a8ef-876d2acf120d
source	Local
decided	2026-08-05

Core is v

Give this page a fresh id?

Anything outside the model that holds the current id will no longer find this page.

Cancel

Give a fresh id

CompanyGraph: complies

An instance is made and moved from Obsidian

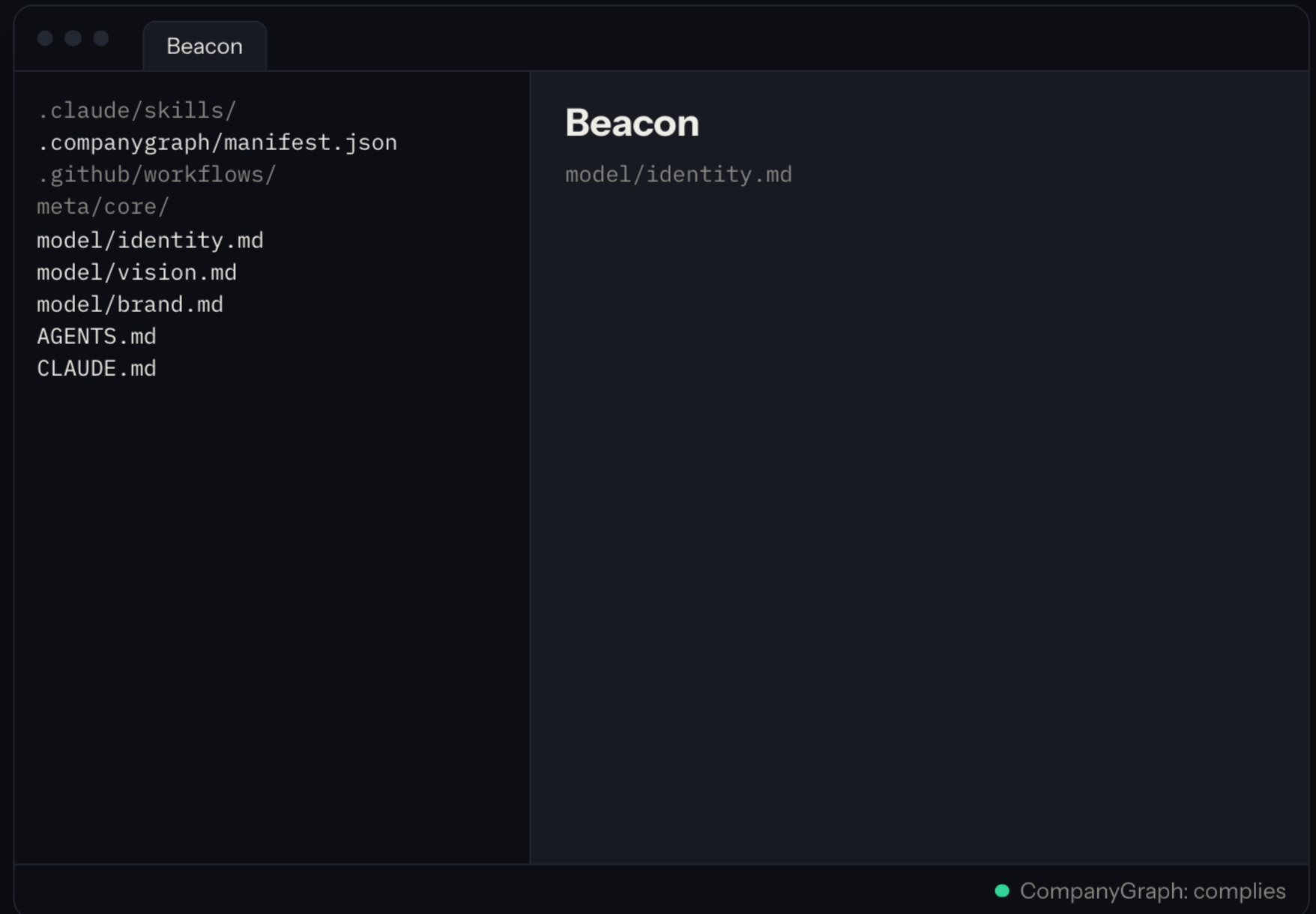
Make this vault an instance writes core, the manifest, CI and the first entities. Move this vault's core takes a newer release and leaves the model alone.

Open the command line opens the meta-model's own, in a tab at the vault's root.

RESTS ON feature An instance is made and kept from one command

concept Core

concept Pin



A note is written back in the family's form

Obsidian's table editor pads every column the moment one cell is edited. The plugin writes the note back in the form the conventions' CI would write, when it is left or saved.

An edit that was undone leaves no diff at all.

RESTS ON

concept Rule

2026-vendored-core.md

Bears on

Written back in the family's form when the note was left

Type Entity Owner How
--- --- --- ---
concept Core changed it
concept Pin made it
concept Instance changed it

git: no change

Four smaller things it does

A picture at the H1

A profile's picture is drawn round at the start of its heading. One that is not square, is outside 256 to 1024 pixels or is over 300 KB fails by name.

The pin, in the status bar

It says pin differs when the manifest names another checker release than the one bundled. The instance's CI stays the gate.

A failing row, tinted

In a Live Preview table, a row that fails is tinted, with its message as the tooltip.

A question's Rests on

Each row reads its type and owner from its own cells, as the checks do, and completes within them.

All of it is in the command palette

Writing

- Complete here
- Add a field
- Add a section
- Remove section
- Open the writing brief
- Write this note in the family's Markdown form

Checks

- Open the compliance pane
- Check compliance now

Entities

- New entity
- Rename entity
- Delete entity
- Copy entity id
- Give this page a fresh id

References

- Open the references pane
- Toggle references in document

The instance

- Make this vault an instance
- Move this vault's core
- Open the command line

Obsidian's own, off in an instance

- Backlinks
- Outgoing links
- Properties
- Tags

It stops at the editor.

The gate a change has to pass is still the checks an instance runs in CI. And the writing rules are a judgment: no check reads them, here or anywhere. The brief puts them where the writing happens, and a person holds a page to them.

RESTS ON `concept Rule` `objective Every gate an agent's work passes is held by a person`

The meta-model's tooling installs it

```
npx --yes 'github:companygraph/meta-model#semver:*'
```

Its menu's Obsidian plugin entry puts the newest release into the vault and switches it on. Run again, it updates the plugin and keeps its settings. The plugin is not in Obsidian's community directory.

RESTS ON `decision` A release is its tag, and nothing we make is published to a registry `feature` An instance is made and kept from one command

github.com/companygraph/obsidian-plugin · github.com/companygraph/mental-model